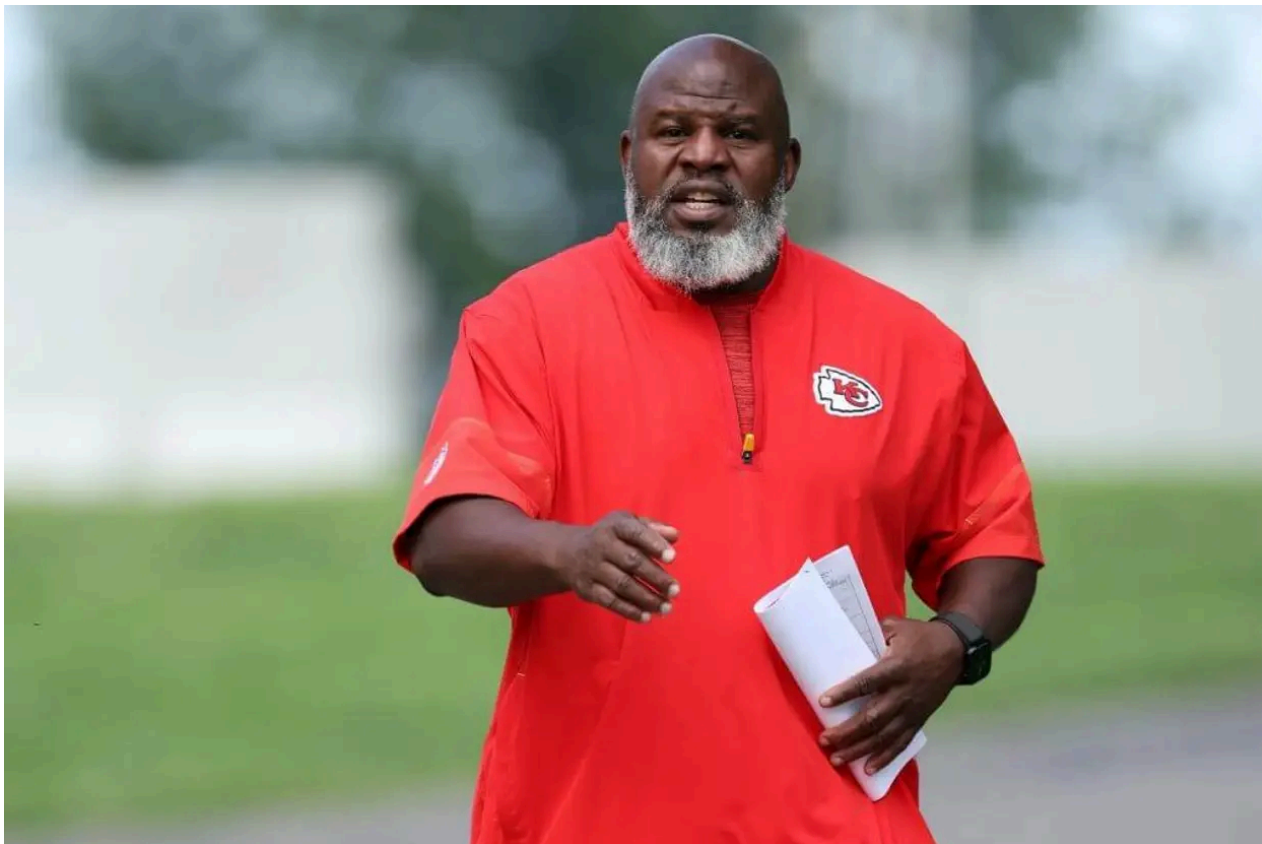


Chiefs offensive coordinator Eric Bieniemy returns to training camp



Chiefs offensive coordinator Eric Bieniemy told fans and well-wishers, “It’s great to be back” as he walked to the practice field Monday. Jamie Squire / Getty Images



By **Jesse Newell**

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ST. JOSEPH, Mo. — Kansas City Chiefs offensive coordinator Eric Bieniemy returned to the team’s training camp Monday following a two-week hiatus after [his wife, Mia, was shot](#) in the couple’s home in Virginia.

Bieniemy told fans and well-wishers, “It’s great to be back” as he made his way to the practice field.

“Good to have E.B. back — back in the fold,” Chiefs coach Andy Reid said after practice. “I don’t think he missed a step. Man, he was out there getting after it. So that’s a positive for the offensive side.”

How Eric Bieniemy's return impacts the Chiefs

Jesse Newell

Bieniemy first left the team on July 27, the day after Mia was shot in Ashburn, Va.

Subsequently, Elijah Bieniemy — Eric and Mia’s son — was arrested and charged after a shooting in which “one adult female (suffered) from multiple gunshot wounds,” the Loudoun County Sheriff’s Office said in a release. Elijah Bieniemy, 27, was charged with malicious wounding, use of a firearm in commission of a felony and discharge of a firearm inside of a dwelling.

Reid said in the days after the shooting that [Mia Bieniemy was “doing better”](#) and “keeps improving by the day.” He reiterated then that there was no timeline for Eric returning to practice.

Bieniemy, though, also remained engaged from afar. He [watched livestreams](#) of Chiefs practices and even called general manager Brett Veach once during drills, telling him to hand the phone to Reid in hopes he would relay instructions to rookie running back Emmett Johnson.

“I was talking to him several times a day, so I knew he was coming back (soon) if everything worked out the way it had been,” Reid said. “The primary thing is Mia is stable and in good hands and she’s doing well.”

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Bieniemy returned to the Chiefs as offensive coordinator this season after a previous stint as OC with the team from 2018 to 2022. He was the offensive

coordinator for the Washington Commanders in 2023.

The couple’s home is roughly three miles from the Commanders’ practice facility.

Chiefs offensive players said they noticed Bieniemy’s presence on the practice field Monday.

“Just being able to have his voice and his coaching points and his energy, it’s infectious,” Chiefs tight end Jake Briningstool said. “It’s great to have him back out here.”

Jesse Newell is a staff writer for The Athletic covering the NFL's Kansas City Chiefs. Before joining The Athletic, Jesse worked as a staff writer for the Kansas City Star, Topeka Capital-Journal and Lawrence Journal-World while covering the Chiefs and University of Kansas Athletics. Jesse has won an EPPY for best sports blog and previously has been named top beat writer in his circulation by AP’s Sports Editors. He is originally from Emporia, Kansas.

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